

Château Haut Brion 2015

CSPC# 801733

750mlx3

14.9% alc./vol.

Grape Variety

50% Merlot, 42% Cabernet Sauvignon, 8% Cabernet Franc.

Appellation

Pessac-Leognan

Classification

Premier Grand Cru Classé

Website

<https://haut-brion.com/#/wines>

General Info

1st classified growth in 1855. Haut Brion was founded in 1525 by Jean de Pontac and since then, many illustrious personalities succeeded each other as owners. The last among them was Clarence Douglas Dillon, American financial minister under the Kennedy government. Today, the continuity and presence of the Dillon family are ensured by Prince Robert of Luxembourg who watches over the destiny of Domaine Clarence Dillon S.A.S., having joined the management of the Company in June of 1997 and succeeding his mother Princess Joan de Mouchy as President at the end of July 2008. Haut Brion is the sole 1st classified growth from the 1855 classification which is outside of the Medoc appellation. Its terroir may be compared to the one of Latour. Even if it is not the more concentrated wine, Haut Brion is the noblest wine of Pessac Leognan, and its longevity is incomparable. The silky structure of the tannins is always exceptional. Classed Premier Cru of the Gironde in 1855, and Cru de Graves in 1953, Château Haut-Brion was also classed thus in 1973, and although this latest classification only concerned the Médoc whilst Haut-Brion is located in the Graves appellation, the minutes of the 1973 classification meeting state: The jury, considering the situation of Château Haut-Brion and its long traditional connections with the Médoc Premiers Crus, and taking into account this tradition, the customs and practices on the one hand, together with its very eminent virtues on the other, has deemed it to be worthy of featuring alongside the Médoc's Premiers Crus Classés

Vintage

A cold winter finishing with an even colder month of March, explains a late bud break. This late start was quickly offset by very mild temperatures from the 10th of April. The early and clustered flowering began at the end of May, the weather conditions in June allowed an even and rapid flowering. The months of June and July were particularly hot and dry. A water shortage led to the creation of small berries and a stop to early growth of the vine. The rainy period at the beginning of August was beneficial in producing a speedy ripening. The harvesting started early and spread out.

Vineyards

Vines have been cultivated here for at least six centuries, in a vineyard once surrounded by pasture and parkland, now by suburban houses. Despite the encroaching reality of the 21st century, within the walls of the Haut-Brion there lies an excellent *terroir*, typical of Bordeaux in that it revolves around two gravel *croupes* - the same can be said for many of the leading estates of the Médoc. These gravelly mounds rise to the heady altitude of 15 metres, a lofty summit compared to much of the surrounding land, providing two south-east facing slopes perfect for the vine. The soils include ancient stones washed down from the Pyrenees over many millennia, Gunzian gravel peppered with quartz and related minerals, hardened conglomerates of stone and flint. All in all, there are just over 51 hectares of vines which are cared for by vineyard manager Pascal Baratié, who also looks after the vineyard of neighbouring La Mission Haut-Brion.

Harvest

between 8 September and 5 October, 2015

Maturation

70% in new barrels during 20 month/s

Tasting Notes

Deep, dark red color. The nose is very deep with powerful aromas of black fruit and spice. The wine starts out quite powerful on the palate, but softens on the middle palate, developing a lovely velvety texture. The finely polished tannic structure is enhanced by considerable concentration and full, luscious body.

Production

11,250 cases made

Cellaring

Drink 2024-2064



Scores/Awards **98 points** - James Molesworth, Wine Spectator - March 31, 2018
100 points - Lisa Perrotti-Brown, Wine Advocate Interim Issue - February 2018
100 points - Neal Martin, Wine Journal - March 2018
98 points - James Suckling, JamesSuckling.com - February 2018
97 points - Roger Voss, Wine Enthusiast - February 2018
18.5 points - Jancis Robinson, JancisRobinson.com - April 2016
97 points - Jane Anson, Decanter.com - November 2017
100 points - Jeff Leve, thewinecellarinsider.com - March 2018
96 points - Tim Atkin, MW - timatkin.com - April 2016
98 points - Jeannie Cho Lee MW, asianpalate.com - May 2016
98 points - Antonio Galloni, Vinous - February 2018
19.5 points - La Revue du Vin France - June 2016
19.5 points - Bettane & Desseauve - April 2016
19 points - Gault & Millau - June 2016
